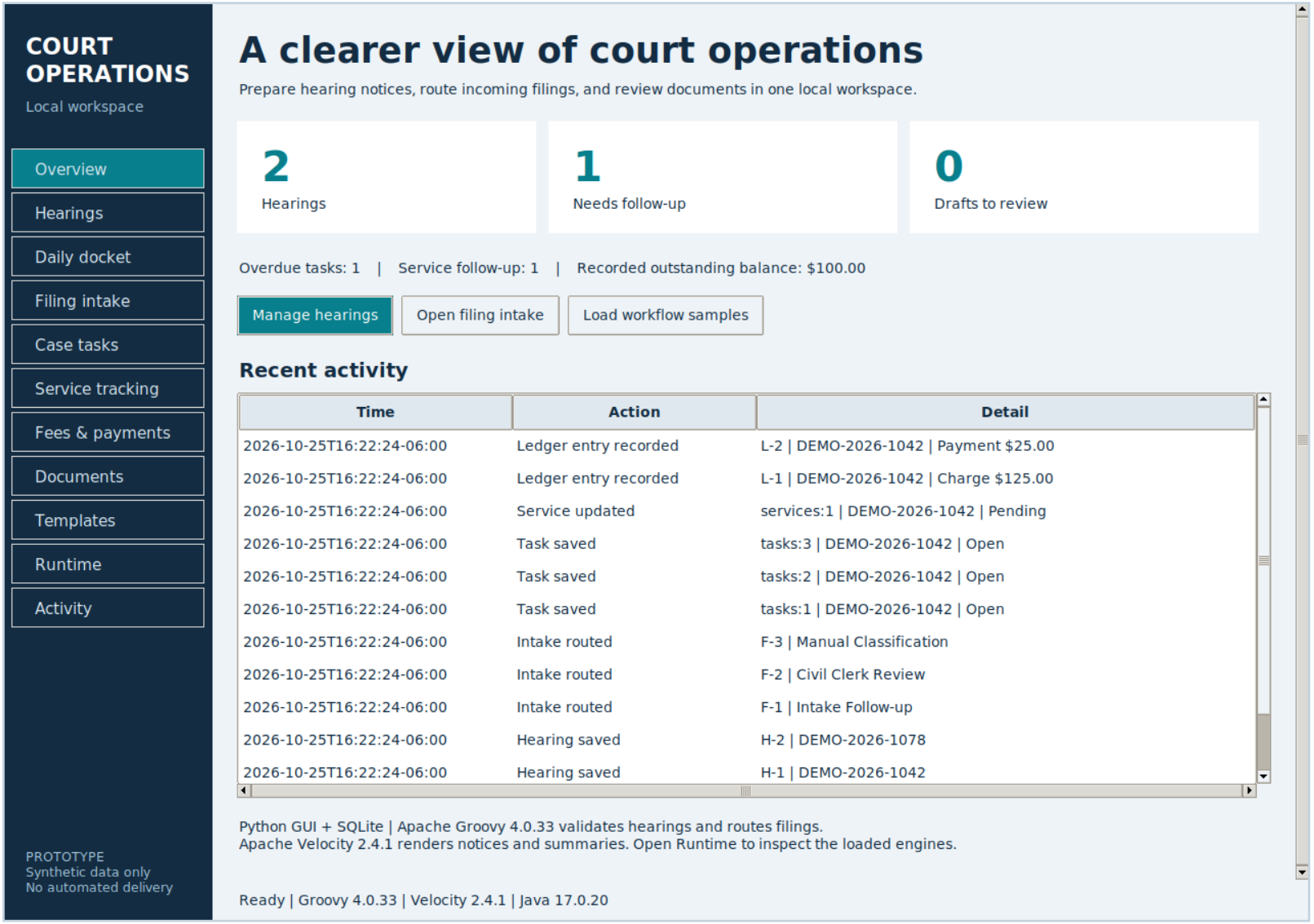
01 Open your workspace

Install once, then launch the desktop app.



1 Launch

Extract the app ZIP. Install Python 3.11+ with Tk and Java 17+. Run python app.py, or use the included Windows launcher.

2 Load samples

On a fresh workspace, choose Load sample records. Existing workspaces can use Load workflow samples for empty new modules.

3 Read Overview

The cards summarize hearings, intake follow-up, and drafts. Below them are overdue tasks, service follow-up, balances, and activity.

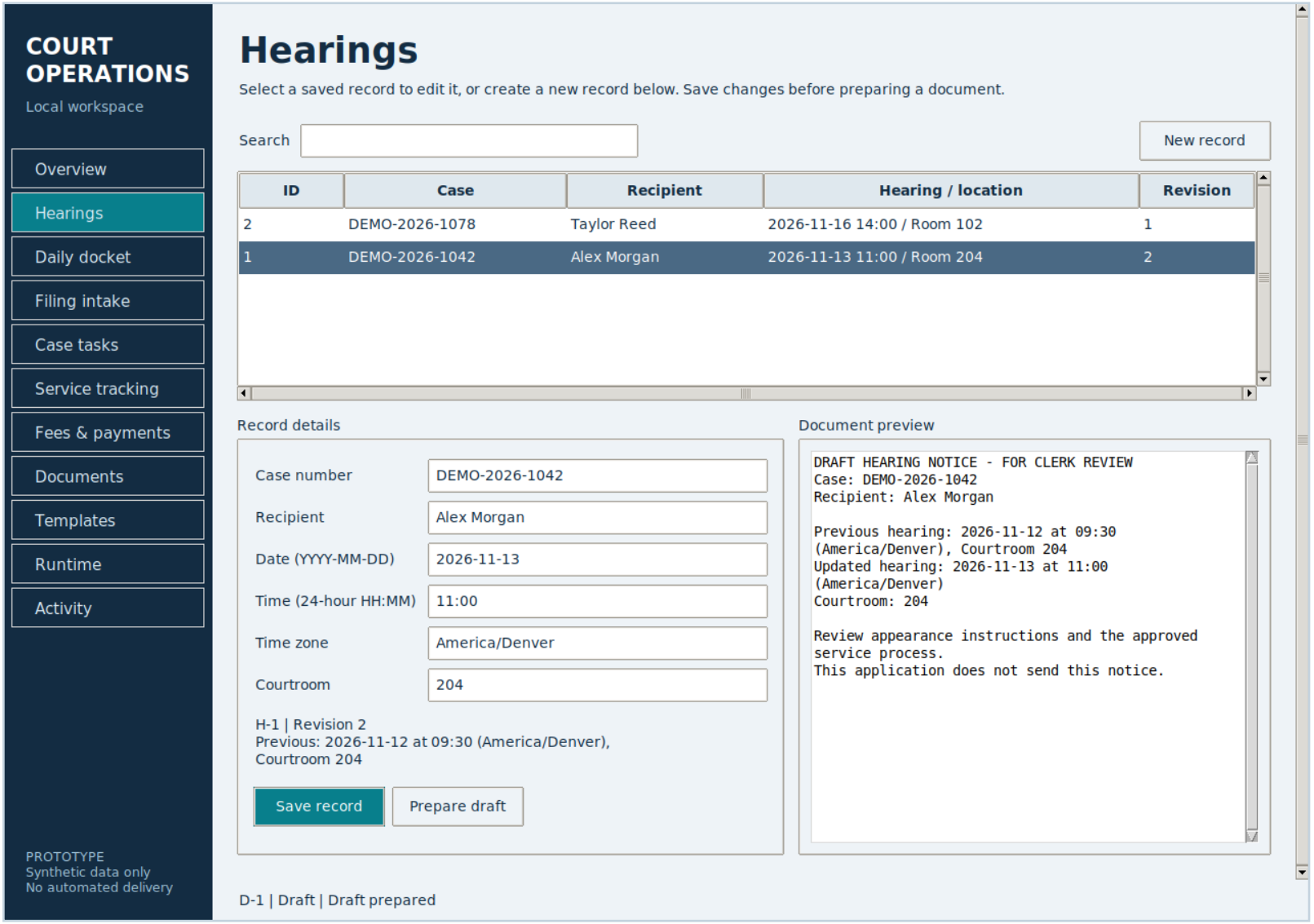
4 Move between screens

Use the left menu. Your records persist locally when you close and reopen the app.

If Windows reports missing time-zone data, run: py -m pip install tzdata. Screenshots use fictional data; task dates are generated when samples are loaded.

02 Change a hearing and prepare a notice

A record change becomes a versioned document draft.



1 Select the hearing

Open Hearings and choose case DEMO-2026-1042.

2 Make a change

Set the date to 2026-11-13 and time to 11:00. Keep America/Denver and courtroom 204.

3 Save, then prepare

Choose Save record, then Prepare draft. Compare previous and updated details in the preview.

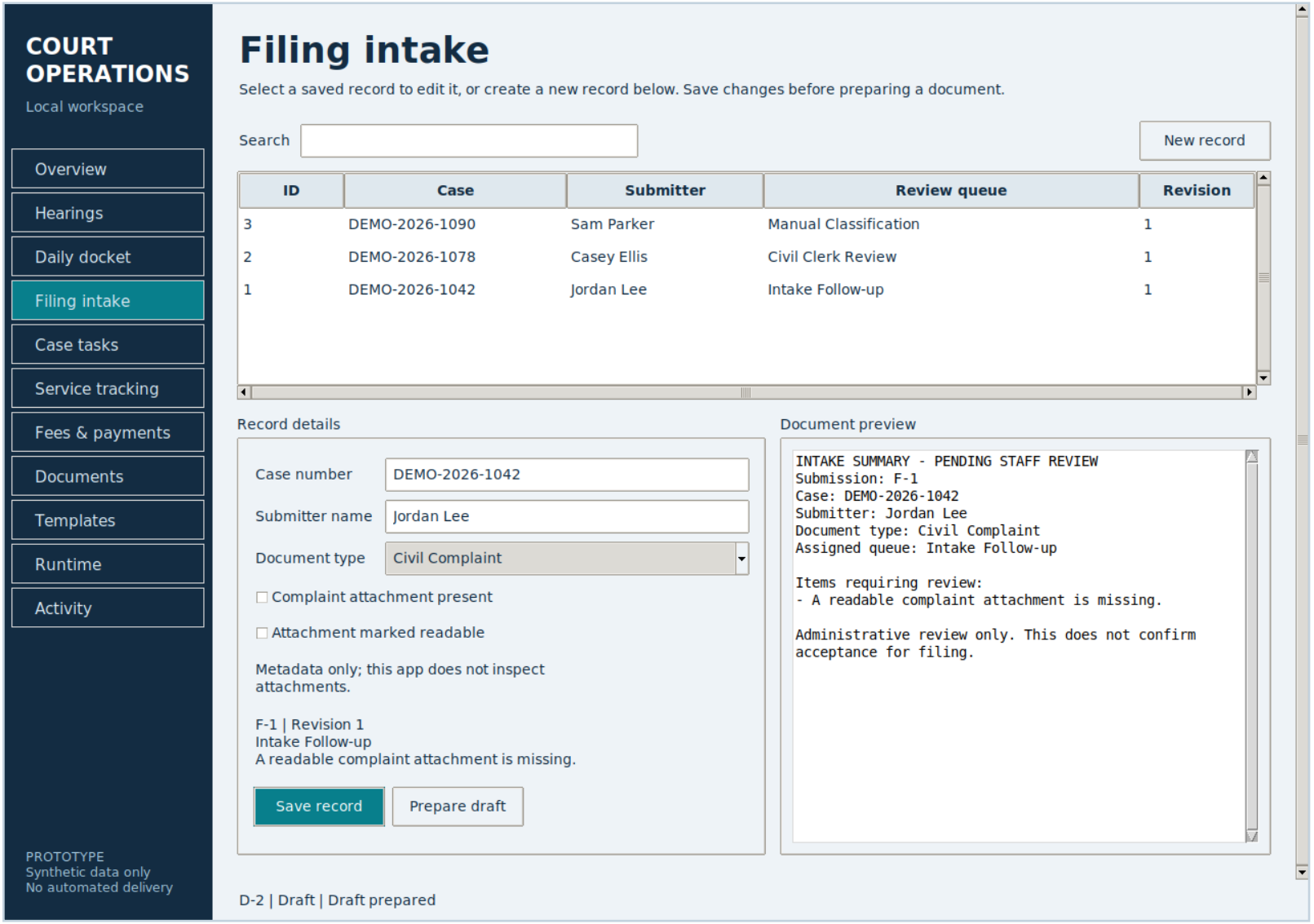
4 Check repeat behavior

Choose Prepare draft again. The same saved revision reuses its draft. A later record change supersedes the older notice.

Expected: revision 2, updated time 11:00, and a draft containing the previous hearing details. Open Documents to review or export it.

03 Inspect a filing and its review queue

Administrative checks make missing information visible.



1 Select the filing

Open Filing intake. Select Jordan Lee for case DEMO-2026-1042.

2 Preview the issue

Choose Prepare draft. The sample is missing a readable complaint attachment and routes to Intake Follow-up.

3 Resolve the metadata

Check Complaint attachment present and Attachment marked readable. Choose Save record, then Prepare draft.

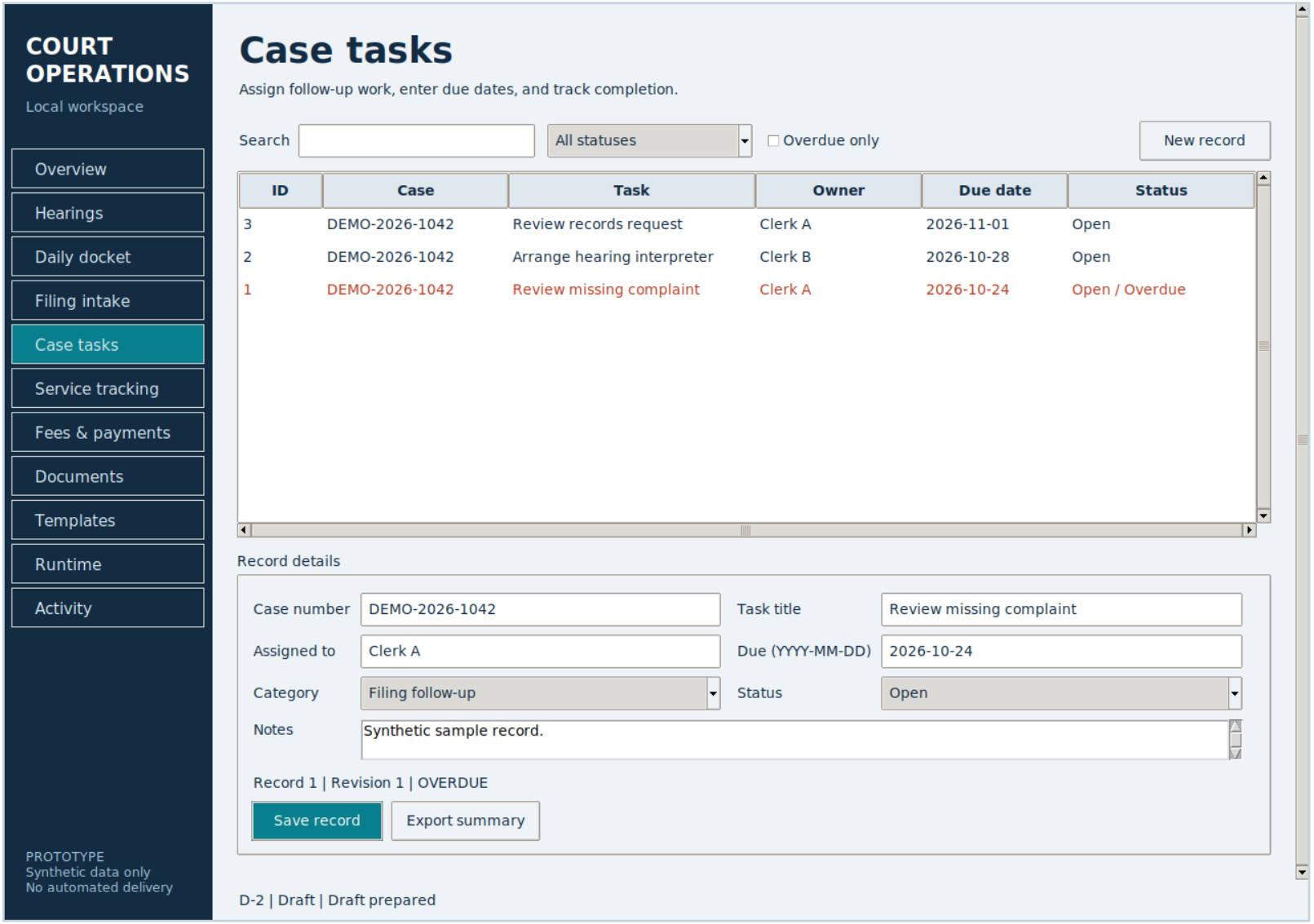
4 Compare the result

The revised record routes to Civil Clerk Review. Other document types route to Manual Classification.

The checkboxes record metadata. The app does not open attachment files, and the checklist does not establish legal acceptance for filing.

04 Assign and complete follow-up work

Use task owners, dates, categories, and status to organize work.



1 Choose a task

Open Case tasks and select Review missing complaint.

2 Assign the work

Edit Assigned to, enter a due date, choose a category, and add notes. Interpreter and records requests are available categories.

3 Track progress

Choose In progress or Completed, then Save record. Use the status filter or Overdue only to narrow the list.

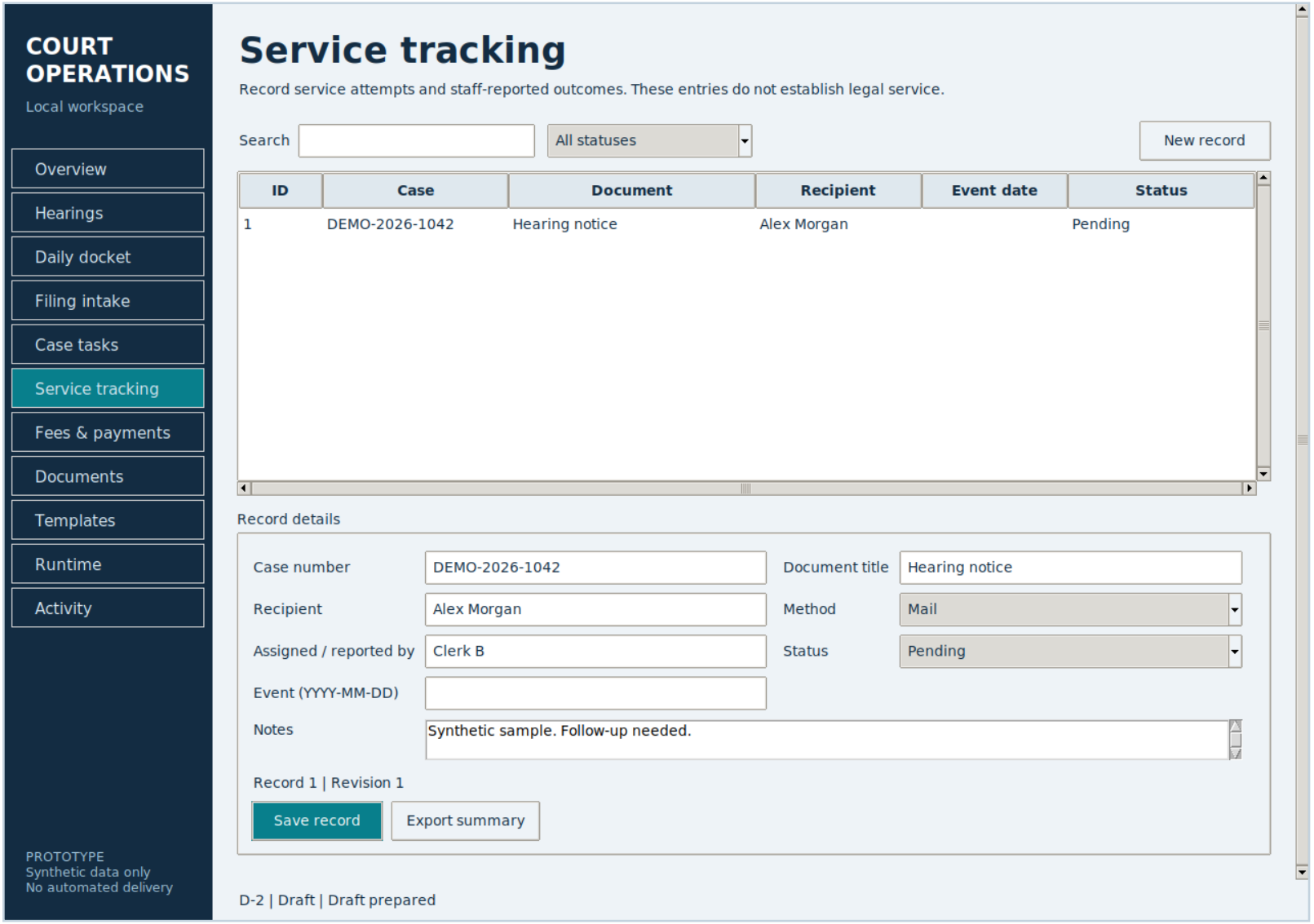
4 Export the details

After saving, choose Export summary to write a plain-text task record.

Open or In progress tasks become overdue after their manually entered due date. Completed and Cancelled tasks are excluded; legal deadlines are not calculated.

05 Record service attempts and outcomes

Maintain a staff-entered record of document-service follow-up.



1 Select a service record

Open Service tracking and select the pending hearing notice for Alex Morgan.

2 Record an attempt

Choose Attempted, enter a past/current event date, record who handled it, and explain the attempt in Notes.

3 Update the outcome

When appropriate, select Reported served or Returned unserved. Reported served requires a reporter and event date.

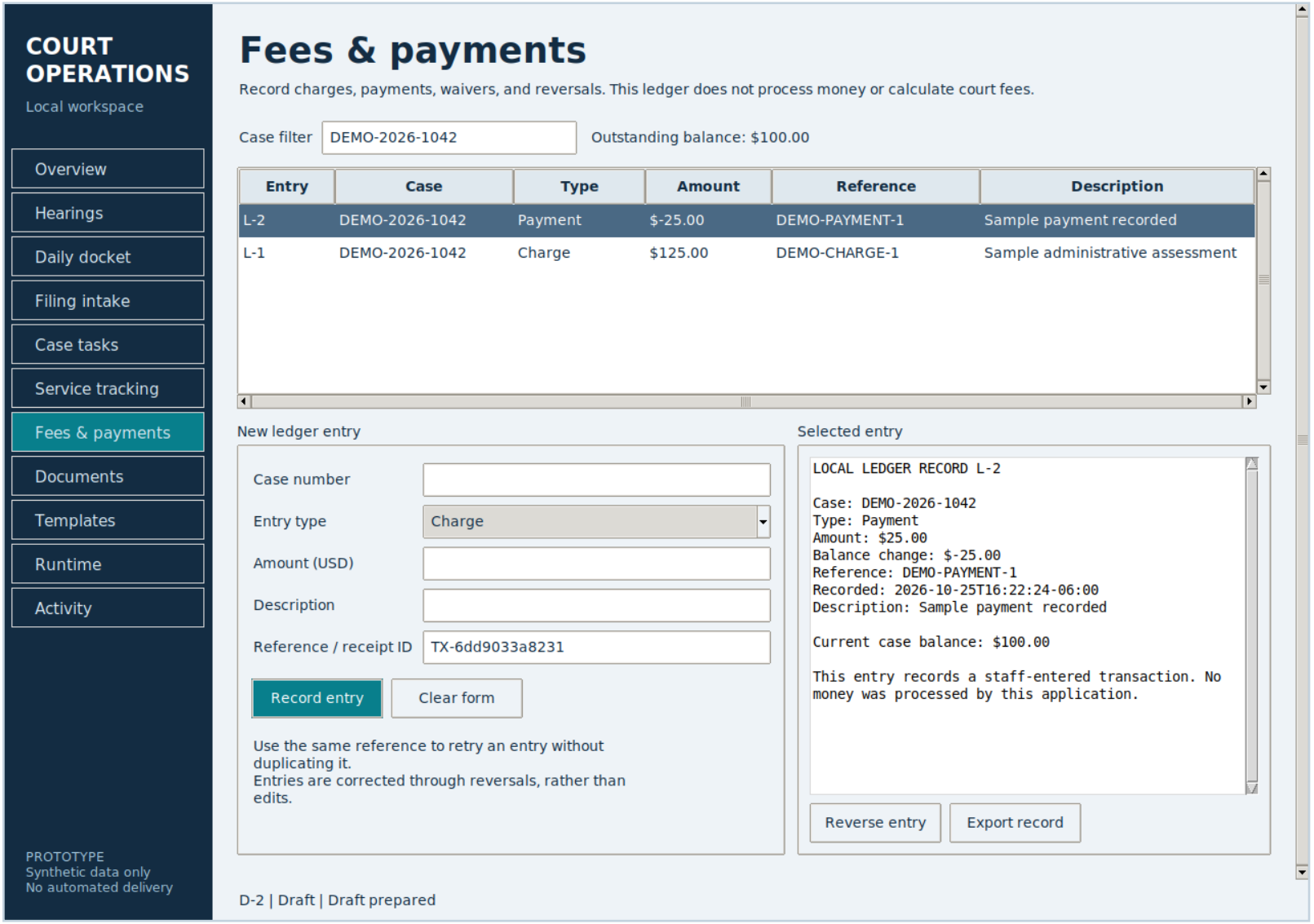
4 Save and export

Save record, then use Export summary. Inspect Activity for the change history.

This screen records reported events. It does not send documents, verify proof of service, or determine whether service is legally valid.

06 Record a payment and inspect the balance

A small local ledger with references and visible reversals.



1 Filter the case

Open Fees & payments. Enter DEMO-2026-1042 in Case filter. The samples leave $100.00 outstanding.

2 Record an entry

Enter the same case in the form. Choose Payment, enter 20.00, add a description, and retain or enter a new unique reference.

3 Test a retry

Choose Record entry twice with the same fields and reference. Only one payment is stored; the balance becomes $80.00.

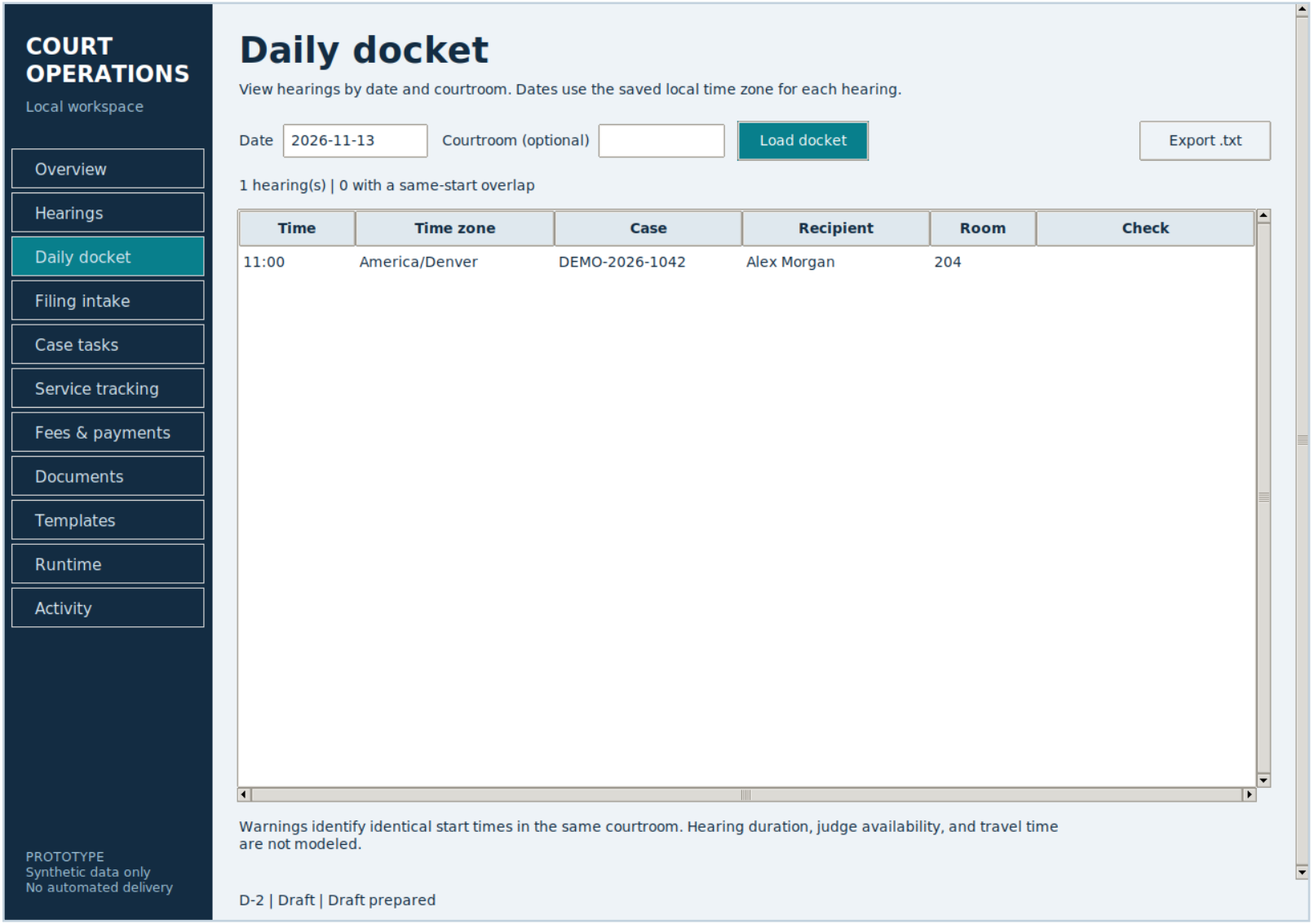
4 Correct a mistake

Select an entry and choose Reverse entry. Enter a reason. The original entry remains, and a separate reversal is added.

This records payments entered by staff; it does not process money. Payments/waivers above the recorded balance are blocked. Export record provides a text copy.

07 Prepare the daily hearing list

Filter the hearing schedule and export a docket.



1 Open the docket

Choose Daily docket. After the hearing exercise, enter 2026-11-13.

2 Apply filters

Optionally enter courtroom 204, then choose Load docket.

3 Inspect the list

Check the case, recipient, time, time zone, and courtroom. A warning flags identical start times in the same courtroom.

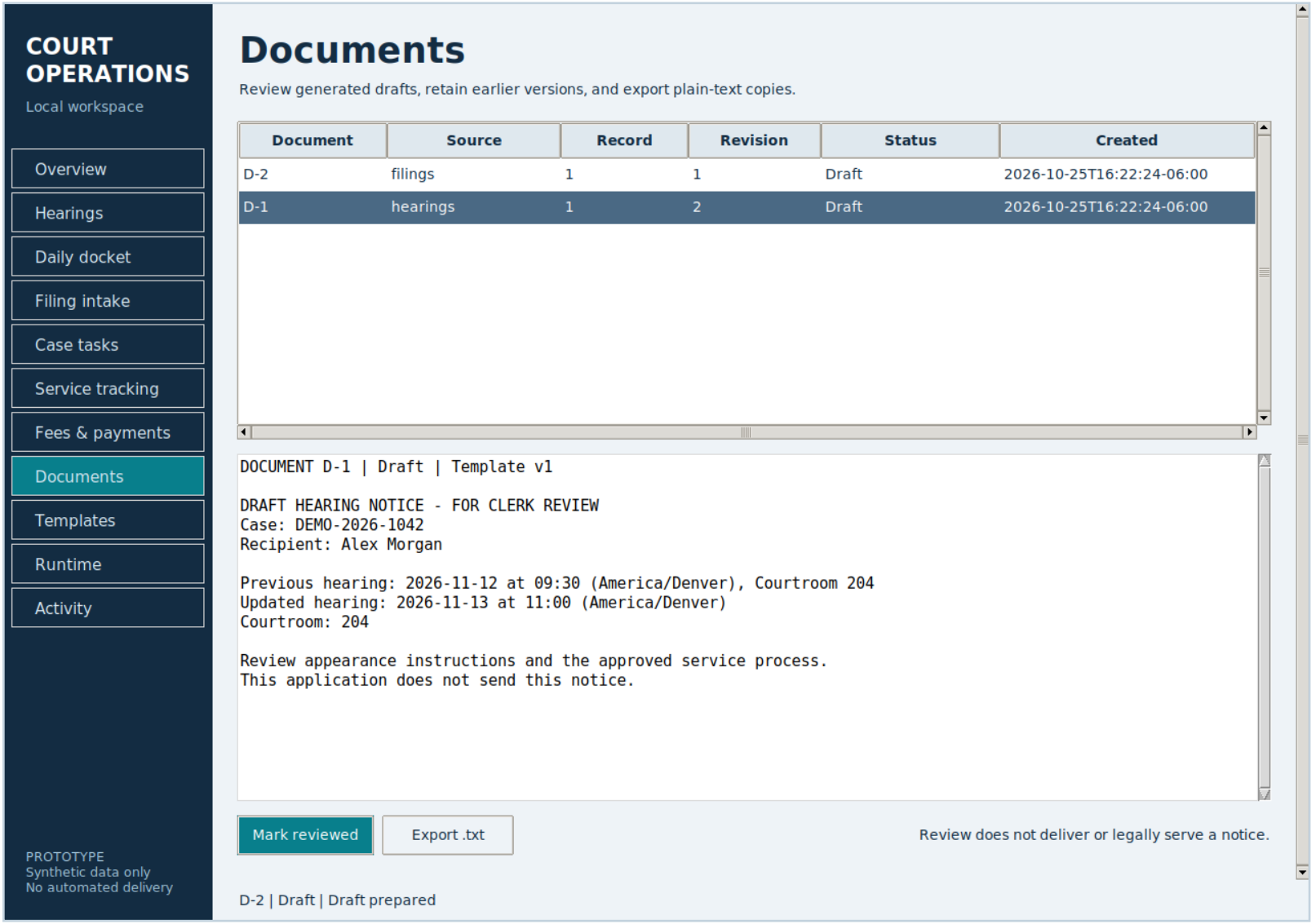
4 Export it

Choose Export .txt to save the current filtered list.

Dates use each hearing's saved local time zone. Overlap checks compare identical starts only; duration and judge availability are not modeled.

08 Review and export generated documents

Keep current drafts and superseded versions visible.



1 Choose a document

Open Documents and select the hearing notice or intake summary created earlier.

2 Check its version

Read the preview and inspect the record revision, template version, and status.

3 Record local review

Choose Mark reviewed for a current Draft. Superseded documents cannot be marked reviewed.

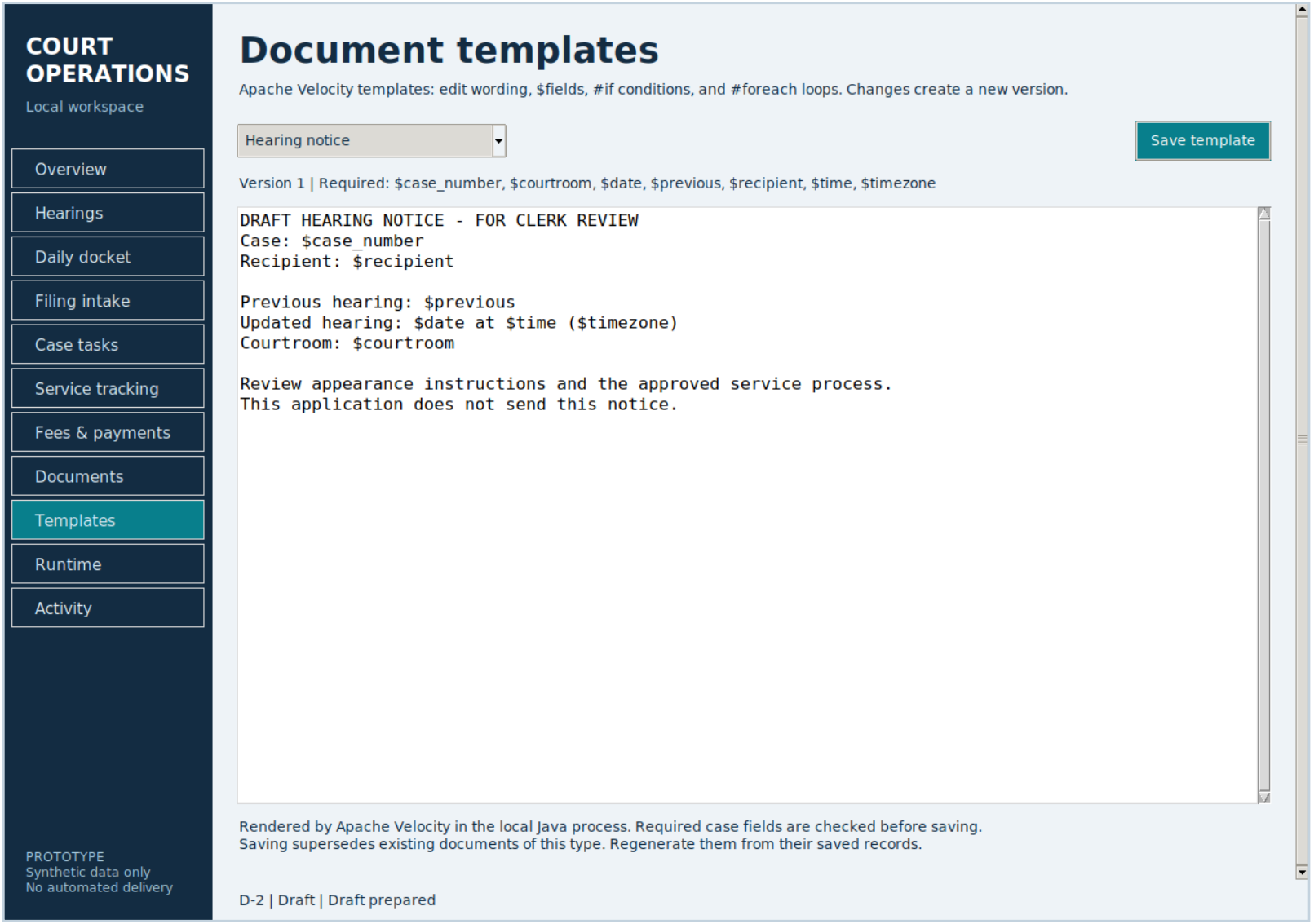
4 Save a copy

Choose Export .txt. The export includes its status and body. This action does not deliver the document.

Reviewed is a local workflow status. Draft wording remains in the template until you change it; the app does not issue or legally serve notices.

09 Adjust Velocity template wording

Apache Velocity merges saved case data into document text.



1 Choose a template

Open Templates. Select Hearing notice or Intake summary.

2 Edit the wording

Add a header or revise the text. Keep listed case fields such as $case_number. Intake summaries use #if and #foreach.

3 Save the new version

Choose Save template. Unknown or missing placeholders are blocked. Existing documents of that type become Superseded.

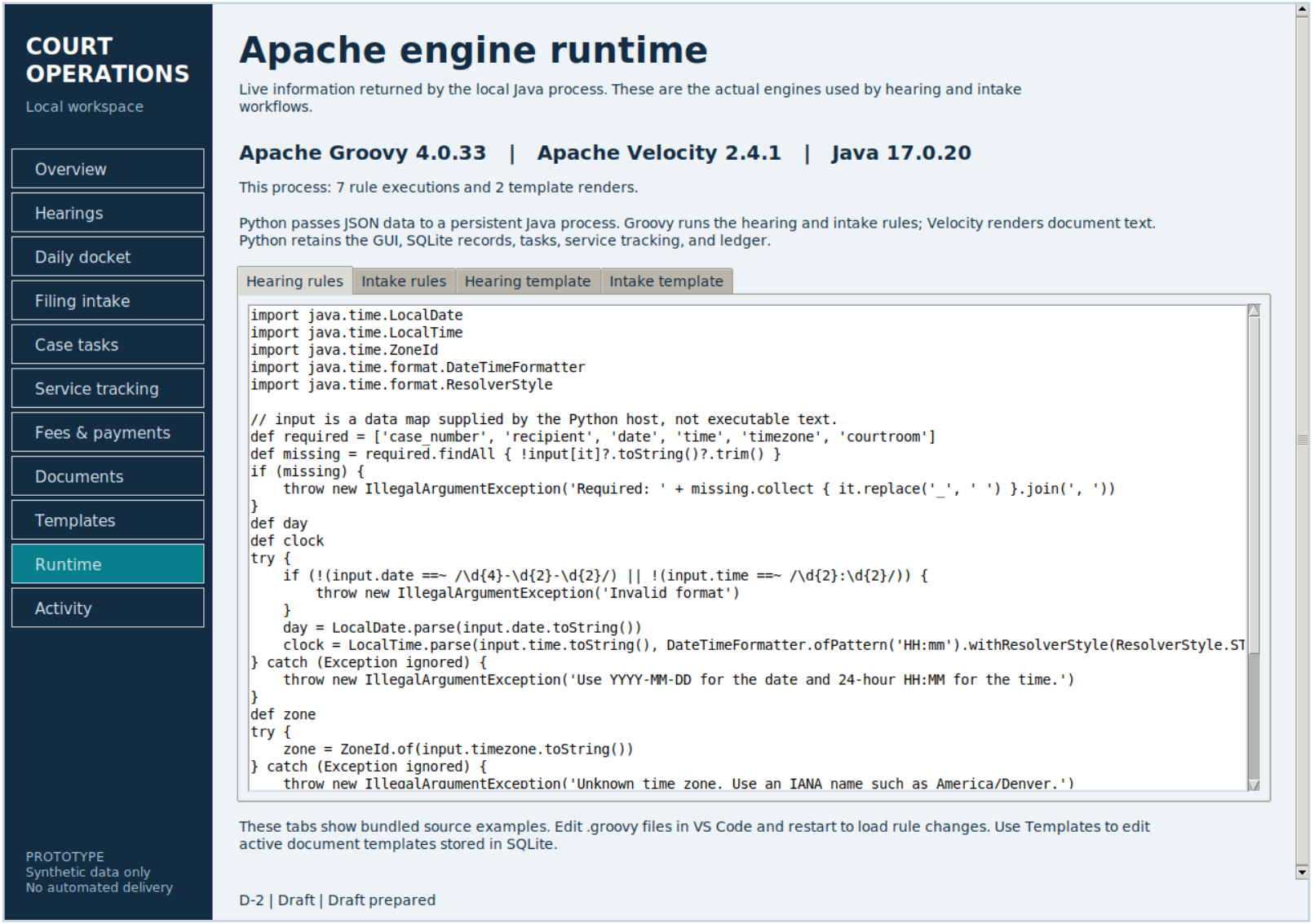
4 Regenerate a draft

Return to the saved hearing or filing and choose Prepare draft. The new document uses the updated template version.

Apache Velocity evaluates the template in Java. Groovy runs the hearing and intake rules. Python retains the GUI and SQLite storage. Existing custom templates may need review when upgrading from the Python-only edition.

10 Verify the actual Apache engines

The Runtime screen displays information returned by the live JVM.



1 Open Runtime

Choose Runtime from the left menu. It reports loaded Groovy 4.0.33, Velocity 2.4.1, and your Java version.

2 Inspect the source

The tabs show bundled .groovy rules and .vm template examples. Active custom templates are managed in Templates.

3 Watch execution counts

Save a hearing or filing, or prepare a draft. Return to Runtime to see the rule/render counters change.

4 Explore a rule change

Edit engine/rules/intake.groovy in VS Code and restart the app. The engine reloads the script; changed routing is applied to saved filings during upgrade.

The flow is Python GUI -> JSON bridge -> Groovy rules / Velocity rendering -> Python SQLite records. Engine libraries are bundled; Java 17+ is required. There is no silent Python simulation fallback.